

TryHackMe: Cache Me Outside

OSINT & Digital Forensics Challenge Writeup

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Date: August 26, 2026	Difficulty: Medium	Execution Time: 30 Mins (Target: 60 Mins)

1. Executive Summary

The **Cache Me Outside** lab tests an investigator's capability to correlate fragmented digital footprints across social platforms, software repositories, and indexed web data. By leveraging Git commit header analysis, cross-platform profiling, and Google Dorking, the entire investigation was completed in **30 minutes**, extracting all critical PII and location artifacts.

2. Investigation Methodology & Execution

Step 1: Initial Profiling (Komoot & GitHub)

- Analyzed the initial chat screenshot between `WKM1337` and `JJ ^_^`.
- Followed the target's public activity profile on **Komoot** (`/user/5667624959836`).
- Extracted the real display name: **Jim Lee**, alongside reference to his GitHub handle (`jiml33t`).

Step 2: Git Metadata Forensics

- Navigated to the user's primary repository `jiml33t/jiml33t`.
- Utilized Git header inspection by appending `.patch` to the commit hash URL.
- Extracted the author's git-configured email from raw headers: `jimleepro1@gmail.com`.

Step 3: Search Automation & Correlation

- Executed targeted Google Dorks using exact-match operators (`"jimleepro1@gmail.com"`).
- Correlated exposed corporate footprints to retrieve the contact phone number: `+40 743 321 239`.
- Identified the target's operating city (**Timișoara, Romania**) and exact transit stop (**Piața Gheorghe Domășneanu**).

Key Security Takeaway: Developers frequently leak personal email addresses in Git commit logs. Even if a profile email is hidden via GitHub UI settings, local Git client headers persist in public patch views unless anonymized email forwarding is enabled.

3. Challenge Artifacts & Answers

Question	Extracted Value	Source / Vector
Full Name	Jim Lee	Komoot & GitHub Profile
Exposed Email	jimleepro1@gmail.com	Git Header Analysis (<code>.patch</code>)

Question	Extracted Value	Source / Vector
Phone Number	+40 743 321 239	Active OSINT / Auto-responder
City Location	Timișoara (Romania)	Corporate Footprint Correlation
Tram Station	Piața Gheorghe Domășneanu	Geographic Location Trace